

Westpac Card Tracker, 11 March 2026

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Quarterly pace moderates further



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The **Westpac-DataX Card Tracker Index** has continued to show a moderation in early 2026 after a strong finish to 2025. The latest reading for the week ending February 28 stands at 153.1, down 1.2pts

from our previous update for the week ending February 7.

Momentum has eased modestly in the recent week, with the quarterly growth pace now running at around 1.0%qtr, down from 1.1%qtr previously. The divergence between international and domestic spending persists. International transactions continue to strengthen, tracking at 5.1%qtr, while domestic transactions remain subdued at 0.7%qtr, the weakest pace since last May.

Discretionary card spending growth edged lower to 0.7%qtr, reflecting ongoing softness in discretionary goods, most notably household appliances. Meanwhile, essential spending is running at a 0.8%qtr pace.

The goods versus services split continues to favour services, which are leading at 1.5%qtr. By contrast, goods spending has fallen –0.1%qtr.

At the state level, Tas is now leading the states with WA closely behind. NSW and Vic continue to exhibit softer trends, with spending growth running at a subdued 0.4-0.7%qtr. Together these two states account for around 60% of total spending but currently they are only accounting for around 40% of growth. Vic has only recently begun to make positive contributions after detracting from growth for several weeks.

The Q4 national accounts significantly undershot expectations with real consumer spend rising 0.3%qtr. The miss was largely due to a 9.5%qtr fall in utilities consumption. Even in nominal terms our card data was signalling a much firmer result.

With around two-thirds of Q1 data now available, spending growth has lost some momentum in the new year, though it is not overly weak. There is a risk of some further moderation, particularly if the RBA hikes again. Consumer sentiment also remains fragile with the March index pointing to rising consumer concern linked to the escalating conflict in the Middle East (see [here](#)).

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